

Blaize Giangiulio

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EDUCATION	Drexel University , Philadelphia, PA Ph.D., Economics; Ph.D. Candidate since September 2024 Expected completion: June 2027 Advisor: Yoto V. Yotov	2022–2027 (expected)
	McGill University , Montreal, QC, Canada M.A., Economics B.A., Economics, with Distinction	2021 2020
FIELDS	International Trade, Applied Industrial Organization, Applied Econometrics	
JOB MARKET PAPER	<i>“Trade Chokepoints”</i> Draft available at blaizegiangiulio.com Trade chokepoints have become targets of armed disruption, yet existing work treats such episodes as exogenous hazards. This paper models chokepoint disruption as a choice. In an $(N + 1)$ -country Armington economy, a disruptor pays a private cost to raise trade costs between other countries, diverting demand toward itself. Disruption improves the disruptor’s terms of trade even absent any geopolitical motive, and the gain scales quadratically in the size of the disrupted corridor. I take the model to the 2023–24 Red Sea crisis using a new measure of logistical distance, computed over a global road and maritime network, that yields a continuous, geography-determined measure of each country pair’s exposure to closure of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait. Trade fell on exposed dyads, with the response concentrated among Western-aligned pairs. In general equilibrium, welfare losses increase with exposure while Iran’s own gains are small. Inverting the disruptor’s first-order condition shows why: at the margin, each dollar Iran gains costs the average Western economy between roughly \$34 and \$103, and pure self-interest can rationalize the campaign only if it cost Iran under \$78 million per year, below even the lowest independent estimate of Iran’s annual support to the Houthis. A strictly positive weight on harming adversaries is required to rationalize the observed disruption.	2026
WORKING PAPERS	<i>“Perceived Protection: Tariff Spillovers to Product Substitutes in the Used Car Market”</i> with Sebastien Bradley, Mian Dai, and Yoto V. Yotov <i>CGPA Working Paper 2026-16</i> Studies the spillover effects of the 2025 “Liberation Day” automotive tariffs on the untaxed U.S. used-car market. Using over eight million weekly web-scraped listings and a VIN-based crosswalk identifying each vehicle’s country of assembly, documents an immediate and persistent 0.2–0.6% increase in the prices of foreign-brand used vehicles relative to domestic-brand vehicles, concentrated among the newest model years—the closest substitutes for new cars—and consistent with demand-side substitution. Foreign-brand vehicles assembled in the U.S. appreciate as much as those assembled abroad, suggesting that the perceived foreignness of a vehicle is largely independent of its true production location. Neglecting tariff pass-through to untaxed substitutes understates overall consumer incidence.	2026

“Logistic Distance”

2026

with Peter Herman, Serge Shikher, and Yoto V. Yotov

This paper employs geospatial network data to construct a novel transportation-network-informed distance variable that integrates realistic city-to-city freight routing into the Mayer and Zignago (2011) population-weighted distance formula, rendering bilateral distances that are meaningfully responsive to infrastructure shocks. Using the 2023 Red Sea crisis as a natural experiment, we estimate a saturated gravity model in an event-study framework with importer–exporter–time and country-pair fixed effects on monthly bilateral trade data. Treated country pairs are those whose network-informed distance rises meaningfully following the closure of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait, identified against a control group of unaffected pairs.

“Dynamic Distance, Trade, and Welfare”

2026

with James E. Anderson, Peter Herman, Serge Shikher, and Yoto V. Yotov

We introduce a time-varying measure of distance between and within countries and demonstrate its usefulness in international economics applications. Built from annual population data for 6,162 cities in 235 countries from 1950 to 2024, the measure improves gravity estimation by enabling theoretically consistent distance estimates in the presence of bilateral fixed effects, mitigating endogeneity concerns related to unobservable factors. We confirm the previous finding that the effects of distance have fallen over time and show that this decline has been driven primarily by affluent countries. Within a general equilibrium setting, we demonstrate that a counterfactual reversion to mid-century distances produces large welfare changes ranging from -1.4% to $+2.4\%$, suggesting that geographic population shifts since the mid-twentieth century have benefited some countries and hurt others. U.S. migration to the South and West has had particularly large impacts on trade and welfare in Canada and Mexico.

WORK IN
PROGRESS

“Shrouded by Statute: Mandated Used-Car Warranties and the Market”

2026

Asks whether state used-car lemon laws, which often require dealers to attach a short express warranty to vehicles sold below sharp odometer cutoffs (e.g., 125,000 miles in Massachusetts), generate price premiums. Using 9.9 million web-scraped listings and a regression-discontinuity design with rich fixed effects, finds no warranty premium, alongside pronounced bunching of odometer readings just above the Massachusetts cutoff and reallocation of near-cutoff inventory across state lines. Rationalizes both facts with a shrouded-attribute model in the spirit of Gabaix and Laibson (2006): when buyers unaware of the mandate are the marginal buyers of covered vehicles, the equilibrium premium is zero regardless of the dealer’s cost; dealers have no private incentive to debias buyers because disclosure raises claims costs, cannibalizes service-contract sales, and is a public good among rivals; and the resulting unpriced cost acts as a tax on covered sales that is shifted onto the quantity margin. Calibrated simulations reproduce the observed magnitudes of both the null price effect and the Massachusetts bunching.

“Drivers of Economic Gains from European Integration:

A Two-Stage Analysis of Directional Effects Across 50,000 Industry–Country Pairs”

2026

with Lionel Fontagné, Nicoletta Scutifero, and Yoto V. Yotov

“EQUIP: Enterprise for Quantitative International Policy”

2025–present

Center for Global Policy Analysis, Drexel University

A large-scale computable general-equilibrium policy-evaluation platform under development at Drexel’s Center for Global Policy Analysis. EQUIP embeds highly granular input–output linkages across industries and countries within a structural gravity framework and is built on state-of-the-art trade and production data, enabling ex ante quantification of how trade-policy shocks propagate through global value chains to sector-level output, trade flows, and welfare.

	<i>“Arteries: A Multimodal Network Graph of U.S. Domestic Freight”</i> 2026 Python package A Python package that fuses highly granular OpenStreetMap geometries for roads, freight rail, ports, and inland waterways into a single routable multimodal graph of internal U.S. goods movement. Intermodal transfer nodes link the modes into one network, supporting route-level distance measurement, freight-flow assignment, and chokepoint and resilience analysis at fine spatial resolution.
PRESENTATIONS	“Trade Chokepoints,” Philadelphia Trade Group (scheduled) Fall 2026 “Perceived Protection,” Philadelphia Trade Group May 2026 “Logistic Distance,” Pennsylvania Economic Association Annual Conference Spring 2025 “Logistic Distance,” Philadelphia Trade Group March 2025 Drexel Sanctions Workshop (participant) 2024
	Drexel University Brown Bag Seminar “Perceived Protection” 2025 “Logistic Distance” 2024 “Dynamic Distance” 2023
FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS	Fellow, Center for Global Policy Analysis, Drexel University 2025–present Dragon Fellowship, Drexel University 2022–present Master’s Teaching Assistantship, McGill University 2020–2021
TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Teaching Awards Dr. Tom Hindelang Outstanding Ph.D. Student Instructor Award, Drexel University 2025 Teaching Assistant Excellence Award, Drexel University 2024 Instructor of Record, Drexel University ECON 201, Principles of Microeconomics Fall 2024, Fall 2025, Fall 2026 ECON 301, Intermediate Microeconomics Spring 2026 Ph.D. Math Camp Summer 2025, Summer 2026 Teaching Assistant, Drexel University ECON 961, Empirical International Trade (Ph.D.) Winter 2025 ECON 201, Principles of Microeconomics Winter 2023–present ECON 202, Principles of Macroeconomics Summer 2025, Summer 2026 ECON 250, Game Theory and Applications Summer 2025 INTB 336, International Money and Finance Summer 2025 BUSN 924, Analyzing Quantitative Data Spring 2023, Spring 2024 ECON 902, Mathematical Economics Fall 2023 ECON 610, Microeconomics Summer 2023 ECON 350, Applied Econometrics Fall 2022 ECON 326, Economic Ideas Fall 2022 Teaching Assistant, McGill University ECON 209, Introductory Macroeconomics 2020–2021

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	Center for Global Policy Analysis, Drexel University <i>Fellow</i> 2025–present Contributed to the development of the large-scale EQUIP trade simulation model; developed a geospatially founded logistic distance measure; built distributed estimation pipelines on HPC clusters (Slurm), scaling to 5,000+ PPML regressions with high-dimensional fixed effects.
	U.S. International Trade Commission, Washington, DC <i>Student Trainee (Economist)</i> 2024–2025 Studied the effect of population movements on international trade flows in a structural gravity framework; used geospatial data and graph-theoretic methods in Python to predict shipping routes and construct a new logistic distance variable; provided technical assistance to USTR.
	Drexel University <i>Research Assistant to Yoto V. Yotov</i> 2022–present Assembled, cleaned, and analyzed data from a wide range of trade sources in R and Stata; prepared summaries of trade-policy research.
PROFESSIONAL SERVICE	Referee: <i>Defence and Peace Economics, Economics Letters, Review of International Economics, The World Economy</i>
SKILLS	<i>Programming:</i> Stata, Python, R, MATLAB, Bash, Slurm (HPC), L^AT_EX <i>Languages:</i> English (native), French (fluent)
REFERENCES AND COMMITTEE	Constantinos Syropoulos (Co-chair), Drexel University, cas86@drexel.edu Yoto V. Yotov (Co-chair), Drexel University, yotov@drexel.edu Sebastien Bradley (Member), Drexel University, sjb355@drexel.edu Mario Larch (Member), University of Bayreuth, mario.larch@uni-bayreuth.de Ohyun Kwon (Member), Wharton (University of Pennsylvania), theekwonomist@gmail.com